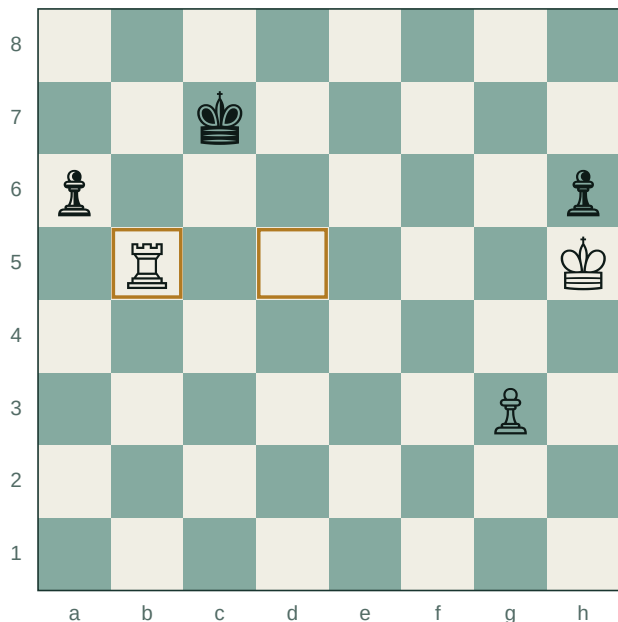


Promotion combinations: Black, move 55

Promotion combinations

Black to move



Previous move: 55.Rxb5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

55...axb5 56. g4 b4 57. Kxh6 b3 58. g5 b2 59. g6 b1=Q

55...axb5 The pawn captures the rook on b5. Recorded reply: **56.g4**.

56...b4 The pawn moves from b5 to b4. Recorded reply: **57.Kxh6**.

57...b3 The pawn moves from b4 to b3. Recorded reply: **58.g5**.

58...b2 The pawn moves from b3 to b2. Recorded reply: **59.g6**.

59...b1=Q The pawn moves from b2 to b1. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 1 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +12. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +12:** the balance goes from -4 to +8. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

HOW TO LOOK

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on h5. Geometrically undefended: rook on b5. Check for tactical protection.